



My Letter of Intent

GUIDANCE TODAY. CLARITY TOMORROW.

A LETTER OF INTENT FOR

Bonnie Marie Anderson

Written by Margaret Anderson — Mother

LAST UPDATED — AUGUST 8, 2026



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TO THE READER

How to use this letter

You are reading this because someone trusted you with the care of Bonnie. Margaret Anderson wrote it to hand you what a family learns over a lifetime — so you don't have to relearn it the hard way.

- Nothing here is legally binding. This letter informs your judgment; it doesn't replace it — or any court order, care plan, or trust document.
- If you are new to Bonnie, start with "A typical day" and "Communication." They will carry you through the first week.
- In a crisis, go straight to "Medical" and "Behavioral support." There is also a separate one-page emergency sheet that pairs with this letter — keep copies where sitters, school, and the ER can grab them.
- Check the date on the cover. Routines, medications, and contacts drift. If this letter is more than a year old, verify the medical details before relying on them.
- No Social Security, account, or policy numbers appear in this letter, on purpose. It says where those are kept instead.
- The ruled lines at the end of each section are for you. Write on this document — it is meant to be used, not preserved.

Thank you for caring for Bonnie.

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IF YOU READ ONE PAGE

Key points at a glance

CALL IN THIS ORDER

1. Jessie — (555) 017-2264. Always her, first, every time.
2. Jessie Anderson · Aunt · (555) 017-2264
3. Hannah Phillips · Neighbor · (555) 017-4417

How to talk with them

FROM "COMMUNICATION"

Talks freely at home, almost never to a stranger. Carries a laminated card and will use it when speaking is too expensive.

Medical facts that cannot wait

FROM "MEDICAL"

Amoxicillin — hives. Bee stings — auto-injector in the red pouch. If stung: auto-injector, then 911, then Jessie. If she has bolted, check small...

What calms them

FROM "BEHAVIOR SUPPORT"

One person talks; everyone else steps back. Lower your voice. Offer the headphones. Say 'You're safe. I'm here. We can wait' — then wait.

What makes it worse

FROM "BEHAVIOR SUPPORT"

Touching her, crowding, blocking the doorway, rapid questions. Never take Forky away as leverage.

Every point above is a summary. The full answer, in the family's own words, is in the section named beneath each heading.

Getting started

YOUR NAME

Margaret Anderson

YOUR RELATIONSHIP TO THEM

Mother

THEIR FULL NAME

Bonnie Marie Anderson

WHAT THEY LIKE TO BE CALLED

Bonnie

TODAY'S DATE

August 8, 2026

NOTES — FOR HANDWRITTEN ADDITIONS

About Bonnie

DATE OF BIRTH

June 19, 2015

DIAGNOSES AND CONDITIONS

Autism spectrum disorder (age 4). Selective mutism (age 5). Sensory differences — sound and texture. Mild anxiety (age 8).

WHAT SHOULD A STRANGER KNOW IN THE FIRST FIVE MINUTES?

Sit beside her, not across from her, and talk to someone else first. She needs to hear your voice before she has to answer it. If she hands you something, take it — that is her opening line.

ANYTHING ELSE THAT MAKES THEM WHO THEY ARE

She is not shy; she is deciding whether it is worth it, and she is usually right. She makes friends out of objects, so please do not throw anything away without asking her first.

NOTES — FOR HANDWRITTEN ADDITIONS

Family and support network

PEOPLE IN BONNIE'S LIFE

Jessie Anderson

RELATIONSHIP Aunt

PHONE (555) 017-2264

THEIR ROLE Backup caregiver and trustee; knows every routine

ÆMERGENCY CONTACT

Hannah Phillips

RELATIONSHIP Neighbor

PHONE (555) 017-4417

THEIR ROLE Has a key; can sit with Bonnie in an emergency

ÆMERGENCY CONTACT

WHO WOULD YOU CALL FIRST IN AN EMERGENCY?

Jessie — (555) 017-2264. Always her, first, every time.

IS THERE ANYONE WHO SHOULD NOT BE GIVEN A ROLE?

Al McWhiggin, a cousin who runs Al's Toy Barn, should not be given any role. He has twice tried to get Bonnie's collection appraised without asking me.

NOTES — FOR HANDWRITTEN ADDITIONS

Communication

HOW THEY COMMUNICATE

Talks freely at home, almost never to a stranger. Carries a laminated card and will use it when speaking is too expensive.

HOW THEY SAY YES AND NO

A real yes is a nod plus 'mm-hm' plus half a second of eye contact. A bare nod means 'I heard you and I want this to stop.'

HOW THEY SHOW PAIN, OR THAT THEY FEEL SICK

She does not report pain, she reports the world getting worse: skipping food she likes, a flat hand pressed on the spot, going to bed early unasked.

WHAT NOT TO SAY

Never 'calm down.' Never 'maybe' — she hears it as a promise. Never joke about Forky being garbage.

NOTES — FOR HANDWRITTEN ADDITIONS

Medical

DOCTORS AND SPECIALISTS

Dr. Rex Pricklepants

SPECIALTY Developmental pediatrics

PHONE (555) 017-3300

CURRENT MEDICATIONS

Sertraline

DOSE AND TIMING 25 mg with breakfast

WHAT IT'S FOR Anxiety — do not stop abruptly

ALLERGIES AND REACTIONS

Amoxicillin — hives. Bee stings — auto-injector in the red pouch.

SEIZURE OR EMERGENCY PROTOCOL

If stung: auto-injector, then 911, then Jessie. If she has bolted, check small enclosed spaces — she hides, she does not run.

PREFERRED HOSPITAL OR ER

Tri-County General — they hold her record and the allergy flag.

NOTES — FOR HANDWRITTEN ADDITIONS

Behavioral support

KNOWN TRIGGERS

A plan changing without warning, which is most of them. Fire alarms. Being told no with no alternative. Someone touching Forky.

EARLY WARNING SIGNS

Narrating out loud to no one — about ten minutes of warning. Then lining things up and sorting buttons. A stranger reads this as playing quietly.

WHAT HELPS MOST WHEN THINGS ESCALATE

One person talks; everyone else steps back. Lower your voice. Offer the headphones. Say 'You're safe. I'm here. We can wait' — then wait.

WHAT MAKES THINGS WORSE

Touching her, crowding, blocking the doorway, rapid questions. Never take Forky away as leverage.

GUIDANCE FOR POLICE AND FIRST RESPONDERS

She cannot answer verbal commands under pressure, and she hides rather than runs. One officer, no raised voice, no sirens, no restraint. Her autism ID card is in her left pocket.

NOTES — FOR HANDWRITTEN ADDITIONS

A personal message

TO BONNIE'S FUTURE CAREGIVERS

Thank you for being with her when I cannot be. You will earn her trust slowly and then have it completely; it takes about six weeks, and she can tell when patience is being performed at her.

When she is difficult, she is frightened. Every single time. And when she hands you a bit of broken junk and tells you its name, she is telling you she loves you.

TO BONNIE

Bonnie —

You were never too much, and never too quiet or too strange. The world is built badly for people who notice as much as you notice, and that is the world's fault.

You see what things could be instead of what they are. Keep making things. Keep the people who take Forky seriously. Let Jessie help you.

I loved being your mother. It was the whole point of me. — Mom

NOTES — FOR HANDWRITTEN ADDITIONS
